



Creative Force Wrestling
Ink & Iron
Episode 1: “The Foundry Remembers”

The Foundry didn’t feel smaller.

That was the first thing Sudio noticed as they stepped into the long, rust lined hallway. The lockers were still there, dented and worn, paint peeling like old scars. The same warm orange lights buzzed overhead, flickering just enough to make the shadows feel alive. Dust hung in the air, untouched, like the building had been holding its breath.

It didn’t feel smaller.

It felt closer.

Sudio walked with her hands tucked into the front pocket of her hoodie, shoulders slightly hunched as her eyes moved over everything. Lena walked beside her, loose and steady, rolling her shoulders like she was already warming up for a match that hadn’t started yet.



“I still can’t believe we’re doing this here,” Sudio said, her voice echoing faintly down the hall.

Lena let out a quiet breath, almost a laugh. “Yeah... of all places.”

They passed an old CFW logo faded into the brick, barely visible under years of grime. For a second, neither of them said anything.

“Big arenas,” Sudio continued, shaking her head. “Lights. Thousands of people.”

She glanced over at Lena.

“And your first title shot is back in this place.”

Lena smirked, just a little. “Feels right though.”

Sudio slowed, her expression tightening. “Does it?”

Lena didn’t answer right away.

The hallway stretched out in front of them, longer than it should have been. The hum of the lights filled the silence.

“It looks the same,” Sudio said after a moment. “But it doesn’t feel like it used to.”

Lena’s eyes drifted to the lockers as they passed them. One in particular. Then another. Like she was counting.

“Places like this don’t change,” Lena said quietly. “People do.”

That made Sudio stop.

“You’re thinking about it too, aren’t you?”

Lena didn’t pretend not to understand.

“MAR.”

The name sat heavy between them. The lights above flickered once, like the building itself reacted to it.

“Yeah,” Sudio muttered. “I heard he’s wrestling again.”

Lena nodded. “Outside CFW.”

“Like none of it happened.”

Lena’s expression didn’t move much, but something behind it hardened.

“Maybe for him... it didn’t.”

Sudio crossed her arms now, rubbing one hand along her sleeve like she was trying to shake something off.

“You ever figure out what that tape actually was?”

Lena shook her head. “No.”

“What it was doing to people... I mean I still don’t...”

“We weren’t supposed to understand it.”

Lena said it calmly. Not dismissive. Certain.

Sudio looked at her, searching for something more, but Lena had already started walking again.

After a second, Sudio followed.

“Well,” she said, forcing a lighter tone, “whatever’s still hiding in here...”

She nudged Lena slightly with her shoulder.

“...it’s not taking that title from me.”

Lena smirked again, a little sharper this time. “You sure about that?”

Something about the way she said it lingered just a second too long.

Sudio slowed again, her eyes drifting over the lockers, the walls, the shadows between them.

“Okay... yeah... nope.”

She shook her head and stepped back slightly.

“I’m not doing this.”

Lena raised an eyebrow. “Doing what?”

“This,” Sudio said, gesturing vaguely around them. “This place. It’s...”

She exhaled, frustrated.

“It’s creeping me out.”

That hung there for a second.

“I’m gonna go grab something to eat,” Sudio added. “Clear my head.”

Lena nodded easily. Too easily.

“Yeah. Go.”

“I’ll meet you after?”

“I’ll catch up.”

Sudio gave her one last look, half checking, half trusting, then turned and started down the hallway.

Her footsteps echoed, softer and softer, until they disappeared completely.

The Foundry went quiet again.

Too quiet.



Lena didn't move at first.

She just stood there, listening.

Then, slowly, her expression shifted. Not dramatic. Not obvious. Just different. Like something she'd been holding in finally settled into place.

She turned.

Her eyes landed on a locker.

Older than the rest. More worn. Like it had been opened and closed more times than it should have.

Lena stepped toward it.

Her hand reached out, then paused just inches from the handle.

A small hesitation.

Then she pulled it open.

The metal creaked, loud in the silence.

Inside, tucked toward the back, something waited.

Lena reached in and pulled it free.

A VHS tape.

Black. Worn. Edges scratched from years of use. Dust clung to it like it hadn't been touched in a long time.

Her fingers adjusted around it as she turned it slightly.

The label was faded.

Handwritten.

Uneven.

Like it had been done quickly or carefully or both.

Lena stared at it.

Her grip tightened just a little.

On the front, in rough black ink, one word.

LENA.

The building didn't make a sound.

But it felt like it was watching.

And somewhere deep in the Foundry, something had just been found again.

